

Pharmacode position may change as per Supplier's m/c requirement & additional small pharma code may appear on the front/ back panel



PACK INSERT
BORTEBIN
Bortezomib 3.5 mg Powder for Solution for Injection

1. Name of the medicinal product
BORTEBIN (Bortezomib 3.5 mg Powder for Solution for Injection)

2. Qualitative and quantitative composition
Each vial contains 3.5 mg bortezomib
After reconstitution, 1 ml of solution for subcutaneous injection contains 2.5 mg bortezomib.
After reconstitution, 1 ml of solution for intravenous injection contains 1 mg bortezomib.
For the full list of excipients, see section 6.1.

3. Pharmaceutical form
Finished product: White to off-white Lyophilized cake or powder in clear glass vial stoppered with gray iglco lyo rubber stopper and sealed with aluminium seal having Tamix blue colour PP disc.
After reconstitution: A clear colourless solution essentially free from visible particles when reconstituted with 0.9 % sodium chloride solution for injection (1 mg/ml for intravenous and 2.5 mg/ml for subcutaneous use)

Bortezomib powder for solution for injection should be reconstituted with 0.9 % sodium chloride solution before administration.

4. Clinical particulars
4.1 Indication
Bortezomib is indicated for the treatment of patients with multiple myeloma.
Bortezomib is indicated for the treatment of patients with mantle cell lymphoma.

4.2 Recommended dose
Important Dosing Guidelines
Bortezomib is for intravenous or subcutaneous use only. Do not administer bortezomib by any other route.

Because each route of administration has a different reconstituted concentration, use caution when calculating the volume to be administered. Intrathecal administration has resulted in death.

The recommended starting dose of bortezomib is 1.3 mg/m². Bortezomib may be administered intravenously at a concentration of 1 mg/ml, or subcutaneously at a concentration of 2.5 mg/ml.

Bortezomib retreatment may be considered for patients with multiple myeloma who had previously responded to treatment with bortezomib and who have relapsed at least 6 months after completing prior bortezomib treatment. Treatment may be started at the last tolerated dose.

When administered intravenously, administer bortezomib as a 3 to 5 second bolus intravenous injection.

Dosage in Previously Untreated Multiple Myeloma
Bortezomib is administered in combination with oral melphalan and oral prednisone for 9, six- week treatment cycles as shown in **Table 1**. In Cycles 1 to 4, bortezomib is administered twice weekly (Days 1, 4, 8, 11, 22, 25, 29 and 32). In Cycles 5 to 9, bortezomib is administered once weekly (Days 1, 8, 22 and 29). At least 72 hours should elapse between consecutive doses of bortezomib.

Table 1: Dosage Regimen for Patients with Previously Untreated Multiple Myeloma												
Twice Weekly Bortezomib (Cycles 1 to 4)												
Week	1			2		3	4		5		6	
Bortezomib (1.3 mg/m ²)	Day 1	--	--	Day 4	Day 8	Day 11	rest period	Day 22	Day 25	Day 29	Day 32	rest period
Melphalan (9 mg/m ²)	Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	--	--	rest period	--	--	--	--	rest period
Prednisone (60 mg/m ²)	Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	--	--	rest period	--	--	--	--	rest period
Once Weekly Bortezomib (Cycles 5 to 9 when used in combination with Melphalan and Prednisone)												
Week	1			2		3	4		5		6	
Bortezomib (1.3 mg/m ²)	Day 1	--	--	Day 8	rest period	Day 22	--	--	Day 29	rest period		
Melphalan (9 mg/m ²)	Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	--	--	rest period	--	--	--	rest period	
Prednisone (60 mg/m ²)	Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	--	--	rest period	--	--	--	rest period	

Dose Modification Guidelines for Bortezomib when given in Combination with Melphalan and Prednisone
Prior to initiating any cycle of therapy with bortezomib in combination with melphalan and prednisone:

- Platelet count should be at least 70 × 10⁹/L, and the absolute neutrophil count (ANC) should be at least 1.0 × 10⁹/L.
- Non-hematological toxicities should have resolved to Grade 1 or baseline.

Toxicity	Dose Modification or Delay
Hematological toxicity during a cycle: If prolonged Grade 4 neutropenia or thrombocytopenia, or thrombocytopenia with bleeding is observed in the previous cycle	Consider reduction of the melphalan dose by 25% in the next cycle
If platelet count is not above 30 × 10 ⁹ /L or ANC is not above 0.75 × 10 ⁹ /L on a bortezomib dosing (other than day 1)	Withhold bortezomib dose
If several bortezomib doses in consecutive cycles are withheld due to toxicity	Reduce bortezomib dose by 1 dose level (from 1.3 mg/m ² to 1 mg/m ² , or from 1 mg/m ² to 0.7 mg/m ²)
Grade 3 or higher non-haematological toxicities	Withhold bortezomib therapy until symptoms of toxicity have resolved to Grade 1 or baseline. Then, bortezomib may be reinitiated with one dose level reduction (from 1.3 mg/m ² to 1 mg/m ² , or from 1 mg/m ² to 0.7 mg/m ²). For bortezomib-related neuropathic pain and/or peripheral neuropathy, hold or modify bortezomib as outlined in Table 6 .

For information concerning melphalan and prednisone, see manufacturer's prescribing information.

Dose modification guidelines for peripheral neuropathy are provided.

Posology for previously untreated multiple myeloma patients eligible for haematopoietic stem cell transplantation (induction therapy)
Combination therapy with dexamethasone
Bortezomib 3.5 mg powder for solution for injection is administered via intravenous or subcutaneous injection at the recommended dose of 1.3 mg/m² body surface area twice weekly for two weeks on days 1, 4, 8, and 11 in a 21-day treatment cycle. This 3-week period is considered a treatment cycle. At least 72 hours should elapse between consecutive doses of bortezomib. Dexamethasone is administered orally at 40 mg on days 1, 2, 3, 4, 8, 9, 10 and 11 of the bortezomib treatment cycle.
Four treatment cycles of this combination therapy are administered.

Combination therapy with dexamethasone and thalidomide
Bortezomib 3.5 mg powder for solution for injection is administered via intravenous or subcutaneous injection at the recommended dose of 1.3 mg/m² body surface area twice weekly for two weeks on days 1, 4, 8, and 11 in a 28-day treatment cycle. This 4-week period is considered a treatment cycle. At least 72 hours should elapse between consecutive doses of bortezomib. Dexamethasone is administered orally at 40 mg on days 1, 2, 3, 4, 8, 9, 10 and 11 of the bortezomib treatment cycle.
Thalidomide is administered orally at 50 mg daily on days 1-14 and if tolerated the dose is increased to 100 mg on days 15-28, and thereafter may be further increased to 200 mg daily from cycle 2 (see Table 3).
Four treatment cycles of this combination are administered. It is recommended that patients with at least partial response receive 2 additional cycles.

Table 3: Posology for bortezomib combination therapy for patients with previously untreated multiple myeloma eligible for haematopoietic stem cell transplantation

Vc + Dx		Cycles 1 to 4			
Week	1	2	3		
Vc (1.3 mg/m ²)	Day 1, 4	Day 8, 11	Rest period		
Dx 40mg	Day 1, 2, 3, 4	Day 8, 9, 10, 11	-		
Vc + Dx + T		Cycle 1			
Week	1	2	3	4	
Vc (1.3 mg/m ²)	Day 1, 4	Day 8, 11	Rest period	Rest period	
T 50mg	Daily	Daily	-	-	
T 100mg*	-	-	Daily	Daily	
Dx 40mg	Day 1, 2, 3, 4	Day 8, 9, 10, 11	-	-	
		Cycles 2 to 4 ^b			
Vc (1.3 mg/m ²)	Day 1, 4	Day 8, 11	Rest period	Rest period	
T 200mg*	Daily	Daily	Daily	Daily	
Dx 40mg	Day 1, 2, 3, 4	Day 8, 9, 10, 11	-	-	

Vc = bortezomib; Dx = dexamethasone; T = thalidomide
* Thalidomide dose is increased to 100 mg from week 3 of Cycle 1 only if 50 mg is tolerated and to 200 mg from cycle 2 onwards if 100 mg is tolerated.
^a Up to 6 cycles may be given to patients who achieve at least a partial response after 4 cycles

Dosage adjustments for transplant eligible patients
For bortezomib dosage adjustments, as described under "Dosage and Dose Modifications for Relapsed Multiple Myeloma and Relapsed Mantle Cell Lymphoma" and "Dose Modifications for Peripheral Neuropathy" should be followed.

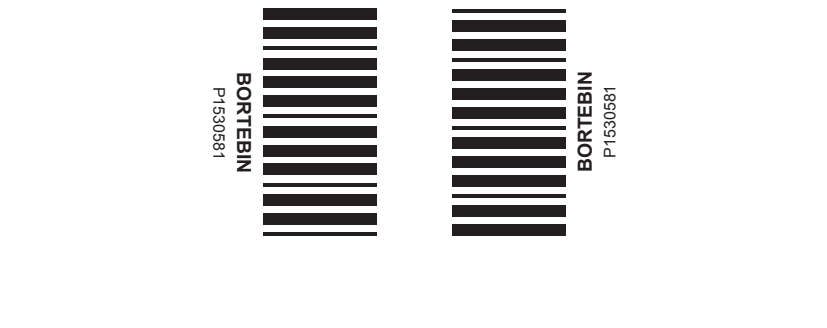
In addition, when bortezomib is given in combination with other chemotherapeutic medicinal products, appropriate dose reductions for these products should be considered in the event of toxicities according to the recommendations in the local package inserts.

Dosage in Previously Untreated Mantle Cell Lymphoma
Bortezomib (1.3 mg/m²) is administered intravenously in combination with intravenous rituximab, cyclophosphamide, doxorubicin and oral prednisone (VCR-CAP) for three-week treatment cycles as shown in **Table 4**. Bortezomib is administered first followed by rituximab. Bortezomib is administered twice weekly for two weeks (Days 1, 4, 8, and 11) followed by a ten-day rest period on Days 12 to 21. For patients with a response first documented at cycle 6, two additional VCR- CAP cycles are recommended. At least 72 hours should elapse between consecutive doses of bortezomib.

Table 4: Dosage Regimen for Patients with Previously Untreated Mantle Cell Lymphoma								
Twice Weekly Bortezomib (6, Three Week Cycles) ¹								
Week	1				2			3
Bortezomib (1.3 mg/m ²)	Day 1	--	--	Day 4	--	Day 8	Day 11	Rest period
Rituximab (375 mg/m ²)	Day 1	--	--	--	--	--	--	Rest period
Cyclophosphamide (750 mg/m ²)								
Doxorubicin (50 mg/m ²)								
Prednisone (100 mg/m ²)	Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5	--	--	Rest period

* Dosing may continue for 2 more cycles (for a total of 8 cycles) if response is first seen at cycle 6.

Dose Modification Guidelines for Bortezomib When Given in Combination with Rituximab, Cyclophosphamide, Doxorubicin and Prednisone



Prior to the first day of each cycle (other than Cycle 1):

- Platelet count should be at least 100 × 10⁹/L and absolute neutrophil count (ANC) should be at least 1.5 × 10⁹/L.
- Hemoglobin should be at least 8 g/dL (at least 4.66 mmol/L).
- Non-hematologic toxicity should have recovered to Grade 1 or baseline.

Interrupt bortezomib treatment at the onset of any Grade 3 hematologic or non-hematologic toxicities, excluding neuropathy (see **Table 6** and **warnings and precautions**). For dose adjustments, see **Table 5** below.

Table 5: Dose Modifications on Days 4, 8, and 11 during Cycles of Combination Bortezomib, Rituximab, Cyclophosphamide, Doxorubicin and Prednisone Therapy

Toxicity	Dose modification or delay
Haematological toxicity	
Grade 3 or higher neutropenia, or a platelet count not at or above 25 × 10 ⁹ /L	Withhold bortezomib therapy for up to 2 weeks until the patient has an ANC at or above 0.75 × 10 ⁹ /L and a platelet count at or above 25 × 10 ⁹ /L. • If, after bortezomib has been withheld, the toxicity does not resolve, discontinue bortezomib. • If toxicity resolves such that the patient has an ANC at or above 0.75 × 10 ⁹ /L and a platelet count at or above 25 × 10 ⁹ /L, bortezomib dose should be reduced by 1 dose level (from 1.3 mg/m ² to 1 mg/m ² , or from 1 mg/m ² to 0.7 mg/m ²).
Grade 3 or higher non-haematological toxicities	Withhold bortezomib therapy until symptoms of the toxicity have resolved to Grade 2 or better. Then, bortezomib may be reinitiated with one dose level reduction (from 1.3 mg/m ² to 1 mg/m ² , or from 1 mg/m ² to 0.7 mg/m ²). For bortezomib-related neuropathic pain and/or peripheral neuropathy, hold or modify bortezomib as outlined in Table 6 .

For information concerning rituximab, cyclophosphamide, doxorubicin and prednisone, see manufacturer's prescribing information.

Dosage and Dose Modifications for Relapsed Multiple Myeloma and Relapsed Mantle Cell Lymphoma
Bortezomib (1.3 mg/m²/dose) is administered twice weekly for two weeks (Days 1, 4, 8, and 11) followed by a ten-day rest period (Days 12 to 21). For extended therapy of more than eight cycles, bortezomib may be administered on the standard schedule or, for relapsed multiple myeloma, on a maintenance schedule of once weekly for four weeks (Days 1, 8, 15, and 22) followed by a 13 day rest period (Days 23 to 35). At least 72 hours should elapse between consecutive doses of bortezomib.

Patients with multiple myeloma who have previously responded to treatment with bortezomib (either alone or in combination) and who have relapsed at least six months after their prior bortezomib therapy may be started on bortezomib at the last tolerated dose. Retreated patients are administered bortezomib twice weekly (Days 1, 4, 8, and 11) every three weeks for a maximum of eight cycles. At least 72 hours should elapse between consecutive doses of bortezomib. Bortezomib may be administered either as a single agent or in combination with dexamethasone.

Bortezomib therapy should be withheld at the onset of any Grade 3 non-hematological or Grade 4 hematological toxicities excluding neuropathy as discussed below (see **Warnings and Precautions**). Once the symptoms of the toxicity have resolved, bortezomib therapy may be reinitiated at a 25 % reduced dose (1.3 mg/m²/dose reduced to 1 mg/m²/dose, 1 mg/m²/dose reduced to 0.7 mg/m²/dose).

For dose modifications guidelines for peripheral neuropathy, see Dose modifications for peripheral neuropathy below.

Dose Modifications for Peripheral Neuropathy

Starting bortezomib subcutaneously may be considered for patients with pre-existing or at high risk of peripheral neuropathy. Patients with pre-existing severe neuropathy should be treated with bortezomib only after careful risk-benefit assessment.

Patients experiencing new or worsening peripheral neuropathy during bortezomib therapy may require a decrease in the dose and/or a less dose-intensive schedule.

For dose or schedule modification guidelines for patients who experience bortezomib-related neuropathic pain and/or peripheral neuropathy see **Table 6**.

Table 6: Recommended Dose Modification for Bortezomib related Neuropathic Pain and/or Peripheral Sensory or Motor Neuropathy

Severity of Peripheral Neuropathy Signs and Symptoms*	Modification of Dose and Regimen
Grade 1 (asymptomatic; loss of deep tendon reflexes or paresthesias) without pain or loss of function	No action
Grade 1 with pain or Grade 2 (moderate symptoms; limiting Instrumental Activities of Daily Living (ADL)**)	Reduce bortezomib to 1 mg/m ²
Grade 2 with pain or Grade 3 (severe symptoms; limiting self-care ADL***)	Withhold bortezomib therapy until toxicity resolves. When toxicity resolves reinitiate with a reduced dose of bortezomib at 0.7 mg/m ² once per week.
Grade 4 (life-threatening consequences; urgent intervention indicated)	Discontinue bortezomib

*Grading based on NCI Common Toxicity Criteria CTCAE v4.0.
**Instrumental ADL: refers to preparing meals, shopping for groceries or clothes, using telephone, managing money etc.
***Self-care ADL: refers to bathing, dressing and undressing, feeding self, using the toilet, taking medications, and not bedridden

Special Populations

Patients with Renal Impairment
The pharmacokinetics of bortezomib are not influenced by the degree of renal impairment. Therefore, dosing adjustments for bortezomib are not necessary in patients with renal insufficiency. Since patients may receive bortezomib concentrations, the drug should be administered after the dialysis procedure (see **Pharmacokinetics**).

Patients with Hepatic Impairment
Patients with mild hepatic impairment do not require a starting dose adjustment and should be treated per the recommended bortezomib dose. For patients with moderate or severe hepatic impairment, see **Table 7** below, (also, see **Pharmacokinetics**).

Table 7: Recommended Starting Dose Modification for Bortezomib in Patients with Hepatic Impairment			
	Bilirubin Level	SGOT (AST) Levels	Modification of Starting Dose in Multiple Myeloma and Relapsed Mantle Cell Lymphoma (1.3 mg/m ² twice weekly)
Mild	≤ 1.0x ULN	> ULN	None
	> 1.0x-1.5x ULN	Any	None
Moderate	> 1.5x-3x ULN	Any	Reduce bortezomib to 0.7 mg/m ² in the first cycle. Consider dose escalation to 1.0 mg/m ² or further dose reduction to 0.5 mg/m ² in subsequent cycles based on patient tolerability.
Severe	> 3x ULN	Any	

Abbreviations: SGOT = serum glutamic oxaloacetic transaminase; AST = aspartate aminotransferase; ULN = upper limit of the normal range.

Administration

Bortezomib 3.5 mg powder for solution for injection is available for intravenous or subcutaneous administration. Bortezomib 1 mg powder for solution for injection is available for intravenous administration only. Bortezomib should not be given by other routes. Intrathecal administration has resulted in death.

Intravenous injection
Bortezomib 3.5 mg reconstituted solution is administered as a 3 to 5 second bolus intravenous injection through a peripheral or central intravenous catheter followed by a flush with sodium chloride 9 mg/ml (0.9 %) solution for injection. At least 72 hours should elapse between consecutive doses of bortezomib.

Subcutaneous injection
Bortezomib 3.5 mg reconstituted solution is administered subcutaneously through the thighs (right or left) or abdomen (right or left). The solution should be injected subcutaneously, at a 45-90° angle. Injection sites should be rotated for consecutive injections.

If local injection site reactions occur following bortezomib subcutaneous injection, either a less concentrated bortezomib solution (Bortezomib 3.5 mg to be reconstituted to 1 mg/ml instead of 2.5 mg/ml) may be administered subcutaneously or a switch to intravenous injection is recommended.

Route of Administration: Intravenous (IV) + Subcutaneous (SC)

- **Contraindications**
- Hypersensitivity to the active substance, to any of the excipients.
- Acute diffuse infiltrative pulmonary and pericardial disease.

4.4 Warnings & Precautions

When thalidomide is used, particular attention to pregnancy testing and prevention requirements is needed.

Intrathecal administration

There have been fatal cases of inadvertent intrathecal administration of bortezomib. Bortezomib 1 mg powder for solution for injection is for intravenous use only, while bortezomib 3.5 mg powder for solution for injection is for intravenous or subcutaneous use. Bortezomib should not be administered intrathecally.

Gastrointestinal toxicity

Gastrointestinal toxicity, including nausea, diarrhoea, vomiting and constipation are very common with bortezomib treatment. Cases of ileus have been uncommonly reported. Therefore, patients who experience constipation should be closely monitored.

Hematological toxicity
Bortezomib treatment is very commonly associated with hematological toxicities (thrombocytopenia, neutropenia and anaemia). Bortezomib (injected intravenously) versus dexamethasone, the most common hematologic toxicity was transient thrombocytopenia. Platelets were lowest at day 11 of each cycle of bortezomib treatment. There was no evidence of cumulative thrombocytopenia. The mean platelet count nadir measured was approximately with baseline. In patients with advanced myeloma the severity of thrombocytopenia was related to pre-treatment platelet count: for baseline platelet counts < 75,000/μl, 90 % of 21 patients had a count ≤ 25,000/μl during the study, including 14 % < 10,000/μl; in contrast, with a baseline platelet count > 75,000/μl, only 14 % of 309 patients had a count ≤ 25,000/μl during the study.

There was a higher incidence of Grade ≥3 thrombocytopenia in the bortezomib treatment group (Bortezomib-CAP) as compared to the non-bortezomib treatment group (rituximab, cyclophosphamide, doxorubicin, vincristine, and prednisone [R-CHOP]). The two treatment groups were similar with regard to the overall incidence of all-grade bleeding events as well as Grade 3 and higher bleeding events. In the Bortezomib-CAP group, patients received platelet transfusions compared to lower in patients with R-CHOP group.

Gastrointestinal and intracerebral haemorrhage, have been reported in association with bortezomib treatment. Therefore, platelet counts should be monitored prior to each dose of bortezomib. Bortezomib therapy should be withheld when the platelet count is < 25,000/μl or, in the case of combination with melphalan and prednisone, when the platelet count is < 30,000/μl. Potential benefit of the treatment should be carefully weighed against the risks, particularly in case of moderate to severe thrombocytopenia and risk factors for bleeding.

Complete blood counts (CBC) with differential and including platelet counts should be frequently monitored throughout treatment with bortezomib. Platelet transfusion should be considered when clinically appropriate.

Transient neutropenia that was reversible between cycles was observed, with no evidence of cumulative neutropenia. Neutrophils were lowest at Day 11 of each cycle of bortezomib treatment and typically recovered to baseline by the next cycle. Patients with neutropenia are at increased risk of infections, they should be monitored for signs and symptoms of infection and treated promptly. Granulocyte colony stimulating factors may be administered for hematologic toxicity according to local standard practice. Prophylactic use of granulocyte colony stimulating factors should be considered in case of repeated delays in cycle administration.

Herpes zoster virus reactivation

Antiviral prophylaxis should be considered in patients being treated with bortezomib. Patients with previously untreated multiple myeloma, the overall incidence of herpes zoster reactivation was more common in patients treated with bortezomib +Melphalan+Prednisone compared with Melphalan+Prednisone. The incidence of herpes zoster infection was higher in the Bortezomib-CAP arm and lower in the R-CHOP arm.

Hepatitis B Virus (HBV) reactivation and infection

When rituximab is used in combination with bortezomib, HBV screening must always be performed in patients at risk of infection with HBV before initiation of treatment. Carriers of hepatitis B and patients with a history of hepatitis B must be closely monitored for clinical and laboratory signs of active HBV infection during and following rituximab combination treatment with bortezomib. Antiviral prophylaxis should be considered.

Progressive multifocal leukoencephalopathy (PML)

Very rare cases with unknown causality of John Cunningham (JC) virus infection, resulting in PML and death, have been reported in patients treated with bortezomib. Patients diagnosed with PML had prior or concurrent immunosuppressive therapy. Most cases of PML were diagnosed within 12 months of their first dose of bortezomib. Patients should be monitored at regular intervals for any new or worsening neurological symptoms or signs that may be suggestive of PML as part of the differential diagnosis of CNS problems. If a diagnosis of PML is suspected, patients should be referred to a specialist in PML and appropriate diagnostic measures for PML should be initiated. Discontinue bortezomib if PML is diagnosed.

Peripheral neuropathy
Treatment with bortezomib is very commonly associated with peripheral neuropathy, which is predominantly sensory. However, cases of severe motor neuropathy with or without sensory peripheral neuropathy have been reported. The incidence of peripheral neuropathy increases early in the treatment and has been observed to peak during cycle 5.

It is recommended that patients be carefully monitored for symptoms of neuropathy such as a burning sensation, hyperesthesia, hyposthesia, paraesthesia, discomfort, neuropathic pain or weakness.

Bortezomib administered intravenously versus subcutaneously, the incidence of Grade ≥2 peripheral neuropathy events lower for the subcutaneous injection group and higher for the intravenous injection group. Grade ≥3 peripheral neuropathy occurred in less patients in the subcutaneous treatment group, compared with intravenous treatment group. The incidence of all grade peripheral neuropathy with bortezomib administered intravenously was lower.

Patients experiencing new or worsening peripheral neuropathy should undergo neurological evaluation and may require a change in the dose, schedule or route of administration to subcutaneous. Neuropathy has been managed with supportive care and other therapies.

Early and regular monitoring for symptoms of treatment-emergent neuropathy with neurological evaluation should be considered in patients receiving bortezomib in combination with medicinal products known to be associated with neuropathy (e.g. thalidomide) and appropriate dose reduction or treatment discontinuation should be considered.

In addition to peripheral neuropathy, there may be a contribution of autonomic neuropathy to some adverse reactions such as postural hypotension and severe constipation with ileus. Information on autonomic neuropathy and its contribution to these undesirable effects is limited.

Seizures

Seizures have been uncommonly reported in patients without previous history of seizures or epilepsy. Special care is required when treating patients with any risk factors for seizures.

Hypotension

Bortezomib treatment is commonly associated with orthostatic/postural hypotension. Most adverse reactions are mild to moderate in nature and are observed throughout treatment. Patients who developed orthostatic hypotension on bortezomib (injected intravenously) did not have evidence of orthostatic hypotension prior to treatment with bortezomib. Most patients required treatment for their orthostatic hypotension. A minority of patients with orthostatic hypotension experienced syncope events. Orthostatic/postural hypotension was not acutely related to bolus infusion of bortezomib. The mechanism of this event is unknown although a component may be due to autonomic neuropathy. Autonomic neuropathy may be related to bortezomib or bortezomib may aggravate an underlying condition such as diabetic or amyloidotic neuropathy. Caution is advised when treating patients with a history of syncope receiving medicinal products known to be associated with hypotension; or who are dehydrated due to recurrent diarrhoea or vomiting. Management of orthostatic/postural hypotension may include adjustment of antihypertensive medicinal products, hydration or administration of mineralocorticosteroids and/or sympathomimetics. Patients should be instructed to seek medical advice if they experience symptoms of dizziness, light-headedness or fainting spells.

Posterior Reversible Encephalopathy Syndrome (PRES)

There have been reports of PRES in patients receiving bortezomib. PRES is a rare, often reversible, rapidly evolving neurological condition, which can present with seizure, hypertension, headache, lethargy, confusion, blindness, and other visual and neurological disturbances. Brain imaging, preferably Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI), is used to confirm the diagnosis. In patients developing PRES, bortezomib should be discontinued.

Heart failure

Table 7: Adverse reactions in patients with Multiple Myeloma treated with Bortezomib and all post-marketing adverse reactions regardless of indication*

System Organ Class	Incidence	Adverse reaction
Infections and infestations	Common	Herpes zoster (inc disseminated & ophthalmic), Pneumonia*, Herpes simplex*, Fungal infection*
	Uncommon	Infection*, Bacterial infections*, Viral infections*, Sepsis (inc septic shock)*, Bronchopneumonia, Herpes virus infection*, Meningoencephalitis herpes*, Bacteraemia (inc staphylococcal), Hordeolum, Influenza, Cellulitis, Device related infection, Skin infection*, Ear infection*, Staphylococcal infection, tooth infection*
	Rare	Meningitis (inc bacterial), Epstein-Barr virus infection, Genital herpes, Tonsillitis, Mastoiditis, Post viral fatigue syndrome
	Rare	Neoplasm malignant, Leukaemia plasmacytic, Renal cell carcinoma, Mass, Mycosis fungoides, Neoplasm benign*
Neoplasms benign, malignant and unspecified (incl cysts and polyps)	Rare	Neoplasm malignant, Leukaemia plasmacytic, Renal cell carcinoma, Mass, Mycosis fungoides, Neoplasm benign*
	Very Common	Thrombocytopenia*, Neutropenia*, Anaemia*
	Common	Leukopenia*, Lymphopenia*
	Uncommon	Pancytopenia*, Febrile neutropenia, Coagulopathy*, Leukocytosis*, Lymphadenopathy, Haemolytic anaemia*
Blood and lymphatic system disorders	Uncommon	Disseminated intravascular coagulation, Thrombocytosis*, Hyperviscosity syndrome, Platelet disorder NOS, Thrombotic microangiopathy (inc thrombocytopenic purpura)*, Blood disorder NOS, Haemorrhagic diathesis, Lymphocytic infiltration
	Rare	Disseminated intravascular coagulation, Thrombocytosis*, Hyperviscosity syndrome, Platelet disorder NOS, Thrombotic microangiopathy (inc thrombocytopenic purpura)*, Blood disorder NOS, Haemorrhagic diathesis, Lymphocytic infiltration
	Uncommon	Angiodedema*, Hypersensitivity*
	Rare	Anaphylactic shock, Amyloidosis, Type III immune complex mediated reaction
Immune system disorders	Uncommon	Cushing's syndrome*, Hyperthyroidism*, Inappropriate antidiuretic hormone secretion
	Rare	Hyperthyroidism
	Uncommon	Cushing's syndrome*, Hyperthyroidism*, Inappropriate antidiuretic hormone secretion
	Rare	Hyperthyroidism
Endocrine disorders	Uncommon	Cushing's syndrome*, Hyperthyroidism*, Inappropriate antidiuretic hormone secretion
	Rare	Hyperthyroidism
	Uncommon	Cushing's syndrome*, Hyperthyroidism*, Inappropriate antidiuretic hormone secretion
	Rare	Hyperthyroidism
Metabolism and nutrition disorders	Very Common	Decreased appetite
	Common	Dehydration, Hypokalaemia*, Hyponatraemia*, Blood glucose abnormal*, Hypocalcaemia*, Enzyme abnormality*
	Uncommon	Tumour lysis syndrome, Failure to thrive*, Hypomagnesaemia*, Hypophosphataemia*, Hyperkalaemia*, Hypercalcaemia*, Hypermagnesaemia*, Uric acid abnormal*, Diabetes mellitus*, Fluid retention
	Rare	Hypermagnesaemia*, Acidosis, Electrolyte imbalance*, Fluid overload, Hypochloreaemia*, Hypovolaemia, Hyperchloreaemia*, Hyperphosphataemia*, Metabolic disorder, Vitamin B complex deficiency, Vitamin B12 deficiency, Gout, Increased appetite, Alcohol intolerance
Psychiatric disorders	Common	Mood disorders and disturbances*, Anxiety disorder*, Sleep disorders and disturbances*
	Uncommon	Mental disorder*, Hallucination*, Psychotic disorder*, Confusion*, Restlessness
	Rare	Suicidal ideation*, Adjustment disorder, Delirium, Libido decreased
	Very Common	Neuropathies*, Peripheral sensory neuropathy, Dysaesthesia*, Neuralgia*
Nervous system disorders	Common	Motor neuropathy*, Loss of consciousness (inc syncope), Dizziness*, Dysgeusia*, Lethargy, Headache*
	Uncommon	Tremor, Peripheral sensorimotor neuropathy, Dyskinesia*, Cerebellar coordination and balance disturbances*, Memory loss (exc dementia)*, Encephalopathy*, Posterior Reversible Encephalopathy Syndrome*, Neurotoxicity, Seizure disorders*, Post herpetic neuralgia, Speech disorder*, Restless legs syndrome, Migraine, Scintilla, Disturbance in attention, Reflexes abnormal*, Parosmia
	Rare	Cerebral haemorrhage*, Haemorrhage intracranial (inc subarachnoid)*, Brain oedema, Transient ischaemic attack, Coma, Autonomic nervous system imbalance, Autonomic neuropathy, Cranial palsy*, Paralysis*, Paresis*, Presyncope, Brain stem syndrome, Cerebrovascular disorder, Nerve root lesion, Psychomotor hyperactivity, Spinal cord compression, Cognitive disorder NOS, Motor dysfunction, Nervous system disorder NOS, Radiculitis, Drooling, Hypotonia, Guillain-Barre syndrome, Demyelinating polyneuropathy.
	Very Common	Neuropathies*, Peripheral sensory neuropathy, Dysaesthesia*, Neuralgia*
Eye disorders	Common	Eye swelling*, Vision abnormal*, Conjunctivitis*
	Uncommon	Eye haemorrhage*, Eyelid infection*, Chalazion*, Blepharitis*, Eye inflammation*, Diplopia, Dry eye*, Eye irritation*, Eye pain, Lacrimation increased, Eye discharge
	Rare	Corneal lesion*, Exophthalmos, Retinitis, Scotoma, Eye disorder (inc eyelid) NOS, Dacryoadenitis acquired, Photophobia, Photopsia, Optic neuropathy*, Different degrees of visual impairment (up to blindness)*
	Common	Vertigo*
Ear and labyrinth disorders	Common	Dysacusis (inc tinnitus)*, Hearing impaired (up to and inc deafness), Ear discomfort*
	Uncommon	Dysacusis (inc tinnitus)*, Hearing impaired (up to and inc deafness), Ear discomfort*
	Rare	Ear haemorrhage, Vestibular neuritis, Ear disorder NOS
	Uncommon	Cardiac tamponade*, Cardio-pulmonary arrest*, Cardiac fibrillation (inc atrial), Cardiac failure (inc left and right ventricular)*, Arrhythmia*, Tachycardia*, Palpitations, Angina pectoris, Pericarditis (inc pericardial effusion)*, Cardiomyopathy*, Ventricular dysfunction*, Bradycardia
Cardiac disorders	Uncommon	Cardiac tamponade*, Cardio-pulmonary arrest*, Cardiac fibrillation (inc atrial), Cardiac failure (inc left and right ventricular)*, Arrhythmia*, Tachycardia*, Palpitations, Angina pectoris, Pericarditis (inc pericardial effusion)*, Cardiomyopathy*, Ventricular dysfunction*, Bradycardia
	Rare	Atrial flutter, Myocardial infarction*, Atrioventricular block*, Cardiovascular disorder (inc cardiovascular shock), Torsade de pointes, Angina unstable, Cardiac valve disorders*, Coronary artery insufficiency, Sinus arrest
	Common	Hypotension*, Orthostatic hypotension, Hypertension*
	Uncommon	Cerebrovascular accident*, Deep vein thrombosis*, Haemorrhage*, Thrombophlebitis (inc superficial), Circulatory collapse (inc hypovolaemic shock), Phlebitis, Flushing*, Haematoma (inc perineal)*, Poor peripheral circulation*, Vasculitis, Hyperaemia (inc ocular)*
Vascular disorders	Rare	Peripheral embolism, Lymphoedema, Pallor, Erythromalgia, Vasodilatation, Vein discoloration, Venous insufficiency
	Common	Dyspnoea*, Epistaxis, Upper/lower respiratory tract infection*, Cough*
	Uncommon	Pulmonary embolism, Pleural effusion, Pulmonary oedema (inc acute), Pulmonary alveolar haemorrhage*, Bronchospasm, Chronic obstructive pulmonary disease*, Hypoxaemia*, Respiratory tract congestion*, Hypoxia, Pleurisy*, Hiccups, Rhinorrhoea, Dysphonia, Wheezing
	Rare	Respiratory failure, Acute respiratory distress syndrome, Apnoea, Pneumothorax, Atelectasis, Pulmonary hypertension, Haemoptysis, Hyperventilation, Orthopnea, Pneumonitis, Respiratory alkalosis, Tachypnoea, Pulmonary fibrosis, Bronchial disorder*, Hypocapnia*, Interstitial lung disease, Lung infiltration, Throat tightness, Dry throat, Increased upper airway secretion, Throat irritation, Upper-airway cough syndrome
Respiratory, thoracic and mediastinal disorders	Common	Dyspnoea*, Epistaxis, Upper/lower respiratory tract infection*, Cough*
	Uncommon	Pulmonary embolism, Pleural effusion, Pulmonary oedema (inc acute), Pulmonary alveolar haemorrhage*, Bronchospasm, Chronic obstructive pulmonary disease*, Hypoxaemia*, Respiratory tract congestion*, Hypoxia, Pleurisy*, Hiccups, Rhinorrhoea, Dysphonia, Wheezing
	Rare	Respiratory failure, Acute respiratory distress syndrome, Apnoea, Pneumothorax, Atelectasis, Pulmonary hypertension, Haemoptysis, Hyperventilation, Orthopnea, Pneumonitis, Respiratory alkalosis, Tachypnoea, Pulmonary fibrosis, Bronchial disorder*, Hypocapnia*, Interstitial lung disease, Lung infiltration, Throat tightness, Dry throat, Increased upper airway secretion, Throat irritation, Upper-airway cough syndrome
	Common	Nausea and vomiting symptoms*, Diarrhoea*, Constipation
Gastrointestinal disorders	Common	Gastrointestinal haemorrhage (inc mucosal)*, Dyspepsia, Stomatitis*, Abdominal distension, Oropharyngeal pain*, Abdominal pain (inc gastrointestinal and splenic pain)*, Oral disorder*, Flatulence
	Uncommon	Pancreatitis (inc chronic)*, Haematemesis, Lip swelling*, Gastrointestinal obstruction (inc small intestinal obstruction, ileus)*, Abdominal discomfort, Oral ulceration*, Enteritis*, Gastritis*, Gingival bleeding, Gastroesophageal reflux disease*, Colitis (inc clostridium difficile)*, Colitis ischaemica*, Gastrointestinal inflammation*, Dysphagia, Irritable bowel syndrome, Gastrointestinal disorder NOS, Tongue coated, Gastrointestinal motility disorder*, Salivary gland disorder*
	Rare	Pancreatitis acute, Peritonitis*, Tongue oedema*, Ascites, Oesophagitis, Chelitis, Faecal incontinence, Anal sphincter atony, Faeculoma*, Gastrointestinal ulceration and perforation*, Gingival hyperthrophy, Megacolon, Rectal discharge, Oropharyngeal blistering*, Lip pain, Periondontitis, Anal fissure, Change of bowel habit, Proctalgia, Abnormal faeces
	Common	Hepatic enzyme abnormality*
Hepatobiliary disorders	Uncommon	Hepatotoxicity (inc liver disorder), Hepatitis*, Cholestasis
	Rare	Hepatic failure, Hepatomegaly, Budd-Chiari syndrome, Cytomegalovirus hepatitis, Hepatic haemorrhage, Cholelithiasis
	Common	Rash*, Pruritus*, Erythema, Dry skin
	Uncommon	Erythema multiforme, Urticaria, Acute febrile neutrophilic dermatosis, Toxic skin eruption, Toxic epidermal necrolysis*, Stevens-Johnson syndrome*, Dermatitis*, Hair disorder*, Pectchie, Eczymosis, Skin lesion, Purpura, Skin mass*, Psoriasis, Hyperhidrosis, Night sweats, Decubitus ulcer*, Acne*, Blister*, Pigmentation disorder*
Skin and subcutaneous tissue disorders	Rare	Skin reaction, Jessner's lymphocytic infiltration, Palmar-plantar erythrodysesthesia syndrome, Haemorrhage subcutaneous, Livido reticularis, Skin induration, Papule, Photosensitivity reaction, Seborrhoea, Cold sweat, Skin disorder NOS, Erythrosis, Skin ulcer, Nail disorder
	Very Common	Musculoskeletal pain*
	Common	Muscle spasms*, Pain in extremity, Muscular weakness
	Uncommon	Muscle twitching, Joint swelling, Arthritis*, Joint stiffness, Myopathies*, Sensation of heaviness
Musculoskeletal and connective tissue disorders	Rare	Rhabdomyolysis, Temporomandibular joint syndrome, Fietula, Joint effusion, Pain in jaw, Bone disorder, Musculoskeletal and connective tissue infections and inflammations*, Synovial cyst
	Common	Renal impairment*
	Uncommon	Renal failure acute, Renal failure chronic*, Urinary tract infection*, Urinary tract signs and symptoms*, Haematuria*, Urinary retention, Micturition disorder*, Proteinuria, Azotaemia, Oliguria*, Pollakiuria
	Rare	Bladder irritation

System Organ Class	Incidence	Adverse reaction
Reproductive system and breast disorders	Uncommon	Vaginal haemorrhage, Genital pain*, Erectile dysfunction,
	Rare	Testicular disorder*, Prostatitis, Breast disorder female, Epididymal tenderness, Epididymitis, Pelvic pain, Vulval ulceration
Congenital, familial and genetic disorders	Rare	Aplasia, Gastrointestinal malformation, Ichthyosis
	Very Common	Pyrexia*, Fatigue, Asthenia
General disorders and administration site conditions	Common	Oedema (inc peripheral), Chills, Pain*, Malaise*
	Uncommon	General physical health deterioration*, Face oedema*, Injection site reaction*, Mucosal disorder*, Chest pain, Gait disturbance, Feeling cold, Extravasation*, Catheter related complication*, Change in thirst*, Chest discomfort, Feeling of body temperature change*, Injection site pain*
Investigations	Common	Weight decreased
	Uncommon	Hyperbilirubinaemia*, Protein analyses abnormal*, Weight increased, Blood test abnormal*, C-reactive protein increased
Injury, poisoning and procedural complications	Rare	Death (inc sudden), Multi-organ failure, Injection site haemorrhage*, Hernia(inc hiatus)*, Impaired healing*, Inflammation, Injection site phlebitis*, Tenderness, Ulcer, Irritability, Non-cardiac chest pain, Catheter site pain, Sensation of foreign body
	Uncommon	Weight decreased
Surgical and medical procedures	Common	Weight decreased
	Uncommon	Hyperbilirubinaemia*, Protein analyses abnormal*, Weight increased, Blood test abnormal*, C-reactive protein increased
Injury, poisoning and procedural complications	Uncommon	Fall, Contusion
	Rare	Transfusion reaction, Fractures*, Rigors*, Face injury, Joint injury*, Burns, Laceration, Procedural pain, Radiation injuries*
Surgical and medical procedures	Rare	Macrophage activation
	Uncommon	Weight decreased

NOS = not otherwise specified
* Grouping of more than one MedDRA preferred term.
* Post-marketing adverse reaction regardless of indication

Mantle Cell Lymphoma (MCL)
The safety profile of bortezomib in MCL patients treated with bortezomib at 1.3 mg/m² in combination with rituximab, cyclophosphamide, doxorubicin, and prednisone (VCR-CAP) versus patients treated with rituximab, cyclophosphamide, doxorubicin, vincristine, and prednisone (R-CHOP) was relatively consistent to that observed in patients with multiple myeloma with main differences described below. Additional adverse drug reactions identified associated with the use of the combination therapy (VCR-CAP) were hepatitis B infection and myocardial ischaemia. The similar incidences of these events in both treatment arms, indicated that these adverse drug reactions are not attributable to bortezomib alone. Notable differences in the MCL patient population as compared to patients in the multiple myeloma studies were higher incidence of the haematological adverse reactions (neutropenia, thrombocytopenia, leukopenia, anaemia, lymphopenia), peripheral sensory neuropathy, hypertension, pyrexia, pneumonia, stomatitis, and hair disorders.

System Organ Class	Incidence	Adverse reaction
Infections and infestations	Very Common	Pneumonia*
	Common	Sepsis (inc septic shock)*, Herpes zoster (inc disseminated & ophthalmic), Herpes virus infection*, Bacterial infections*, Upper/lower respiratory tract infection*, Fungal infection*, Herpes simplex*
	Uncommon	Hepatitis B, Infection*, Bronchopneumonia
	Very Common	Thrombocytopenia*, Febrile neutropenia, Neutropenia*, Leukopenia*, Anaemia*, Lymphopenia*
Blood and lymphatic system disorders	Uncommon	Pancytopenia*
	Common	Hypersensitivity*
	Uncommon	Anaphylactic reaction
Immune system disorders	Very Common	Decreased appetite
	Common	Hypokalaemia*, Blood glucose abnormal*, Hyponatraemia*, Diabetes mellitus*, Fluid retention
	Uncommon	Tumour lysis syndrome
	Common	Sleep disorders and disturbances*
Metabolism and nutrition disorders	Very Common	Peripheral sensory neuropathy, Dysaesthesia*, Neuralgia*
	Common	Neuropathies*, Motor neuropathy*, Loss of consciousness (inc syncope), Encephalopathy*, Peripheral sensorimotor neuropathy, Dizziness*, Dysgeusia*, Autonomic neuropathy
	Uncommon	Autonomic nervous system imbalance
	Common	Vision abnormal*
Psychiatric disorders	Common	Dysacusis (inc tinnitus)*
	Uncommon	Vertigo*, Hearing impaired (up to and inc deafness)
	Common	Cardiac fibrillation (inc atrial), Arrhythmia*, Cardiac failure (inc left and right ventricular)*, Myocardial ischaemia, Ventricular dysfunction*
	Uncommon	Cardiovascular disorder (inc cardiogenic shock)
Eye disorders	Common	Hypertension*, Hypotension*, Orthostatic hypotension
	Common	Dyspnoea*, Cough*, Hiccups
	Uncommon	Acute respiratory distress syndrome, Pulmonary embolism, Pneumonitis, Pulmonary hypertension, Pulmonary oedema (inc acute)
	Common	Nausea and vomiting symptoms*, Diarrhoea*, Stomatitis*, Constipation
Ear and labyrinth disorders	Common	Gastrointestinal haemorrhage (inc mucosal)*, Abdominal distension, Dyspepsia, Oropharyngeal pain*, Gastritis*, Oral ulceration*, Abdominal discomfort, Dysphagia, Gastrointestinal inflammation*, Abdominal pain (inc gastrointestinal and splenic pain)*, Oral disorder*
	Uncommon	Colitis (inc clostridium difficile)*
Gastrointestinal disorders	Common	Hepatotoxicity (inc liver disorder)
	Uncommon	Hepatic failure
Hepatobiliary disorders	Very Common	Hair disorder*
	Common	Pruritus*, Dermatitis*, Rash*
	Common	Muscle spasms*, Musculoskeletal pain*, Pain in extremity
	Common	Urinary tract infection*
Skin and subcutaneous tissue disorders	Very Common	Pyrexia*, Fatigue, Asthenia
	Common	Oedema (inc peripheral), Chills, Injection site reaction*, Malaise*
	Common	Hyperbilirubinaemia*, Protein analyses abnormal*, Weight decreased, Weight increased
	Common	Nausea and vomiting symptoms*, Diarrhoea*, Stomatitis*, Constipation
Musculoskeletal and connective tissue disorders	Common	Gastrointestinal haemorrhage (inc mucosal)*, Abdominal distension, Dyspepsia, Oropharyngeal pain*, Gastritis*, Oral ulceration*, Abdominal discomfort, Dysphagia, Gastrointestinal inflammation*, Abdominal pain (inc gastrointestinal and splenic pain)*, Oral disorder*
	Uncommon	Colitis (inc clostridium difficile)*
Renal and urinary disorders	Common	Hepatotoxicity (inc liver disorder), Hepatitis*, Cholestasis
	Uncommon	Hepatic failure
	Very Common	Hair disorder*
	Common	Pruritus*, Dermatitis*, Rash*
General disorders and administration site conditions	Common	Muscle spasms*, Musculoskeletal pain*, Pain in extremity
	Common	Urinary tract infection*
	Very Common	Pyrexia*, Fatigue, Asthenia
	Common	Oedema (inc peripheral), Chills, Injection site reaction*, Malaise*
Investigations	Common	Hyperbilirubinaemia*, Protein analyses abnormal*, Weight decreased, Weight increased
	Common	Nausea and vomiting symptoms*, Diarrhoea*, Stomatitis*, Constipation
	Common	Gastrointestinal haemorrhage (inc mucosal)*, Abdominal distension, Dyspepsia, Oropharyngeal pain*, Gastritis*, Oral ulceration*, Abdominal discomfort, Dysphagia, Gastrointestinal inflammation*, Abdominal pain (inc gastrointestinal and splenic pain)*, Oral disorder*
	Uncommon	Colitis (inc clostridium difficile)*
Hepatobiliary disorders	Common	Hepatotoxicity (inc liver disorder)
	Uncommon	Hepatic failure
	Very Common	Hair disorder*
	Common	Pruritus*, Dermatitis*, Rash*
Skin and subcutaneous tissue disorders	Common	Muscle spasms*, Musculoskeletal pain*, Pain in extremity
	Common	Urinary tract infection*
	Very Common	Pyrexia*, Fatigue, Asthenia
	Common	Oedema (inc peripheral), Chills, Injection site reaction*, Malaise*
General disorders and administration site conditions	Common	Hyperbilirubinaemia*, Protein analyses abnormal*, Weight decreased, Weight increased
	Common	Nausea and vomiting symptoms*, Diarrhoea*, Stomatitis*, Constipation
	Common	Gastrointestinal haemorrhage (inc mucosal)*, Abdominal distension, Dyspepsia, Oropharyngeal pain*, Gastritis*, Oral ulceration*, Abdominal discomfort, Dysphagia, Gastrointestinal inflammation*, Abdominal pain (inc gastrointestinal and splenic pain)*, Oral disorder*
	Uncommon	Colitis (inc clostridium difficile)*
Musculoskeletal and connective tissue disorders	Common	Hepatotoxicity (inc liver disorder), Hepatitis*, Cholestasis
	Uncommon	Hepatic failure
	Very Common	Hair disorder*
	Common	Pruritus*, Dermatitis*, Rash*
Renal and urinary disorders	Common	Muscle spasms*, Musculoskeletal pain*, Pain in extremity
	Common	Urinary tract infection*
	Very Common	Pyrexia*, Fatigue, Asthenia
	Common	Oedema (inc peripheral), Chills, Injection site reaction*, Malaise*
Investigations	Common	Hyperbilirubinaemia*, Protein analyses abnormal*, Weight decreased, Weight increased
	Common	Nausea and vomiting symptoms*, Diarrhoea*, Stomatitis*, Constipation
	Common	Gastrointestinal haemorrhage (inc mucosal)*, Abdominal distension, Dyspepsia, Oropharyngeal pain*, Gastritis*, Oral ulceration*, Abdominal discomfort, Dysphagia, Gastrointestinal inflammation*, Abdominal pain (inc gastrointestinal and splenic pain)*, Oral disorder*
	Uncommon	Colitis (inc clostridium difficile)*

* Grouping of more than one MedDRA preferred term.
Description of selected adverse reactions
Herpes zoster virus reactivation

Multiple Myeloma
The incidence of herpes zoster among patients receiving Vc-M+P treatment group was 17 % for patients not administered antiviral prophylaxis compared to 3 % for patients administered antiviral prophylaxis.

Mantle cell lymphoma
The incidence of herpes zoster among patients receiving VCR-CAP arm was 10.7 % for patients not administered antiviral prophylaxis compared to 3 % for patients administered antiviral prophylaxis.

Hepatitis B Virus (HBV) reactivation and infection
Mantle cell lymphoma
The overall incidence of hepatitis B infections was similar in patients treated with VCR-CAP or with R-CHOP.

Peripheral neuropathy in combination regimens
Multiple Myeloma
The incidence of peripheral neuropathy in the combination regimens is presented in the table below:

	VDx	VcDx	TDx	VcTDx
Incidence of PN (%)				
All Grade PN	3	15	12	45
≥ Grade 2 PN	1	10	2	31
≥ Grade 3 PN	< 1	5	0	5
Discontinuation due to PN (%)	< 1	2	1	5

VDx = vincristine, doxorubicin, dexamethasone; VcDx = bortezomib, dexamethasone; TDx = thalidomide, dexamethasone; VcTDx = bortezomib, thalidomide, dexamethasone; PN = peripheral neuropathy
Note: Peripheral neuropathy included the preferred terms: neuropathy peripheral, peripheral motor neuropathy, peripheral sensory neuropathy, and polyneuropathy.

Mantle cell lymphoma
The incidence of peripheral neuropathy in the combination regimens is presented in the table below:
Table 10: Incidence of peripheral neuropathy by toxicity and treatment discontinuation due to peripheral neuropathy

	VcR-CAP	R-CHOP
Incidence of PN (%)		
All GradePN	30	29
≥ Grade 2 PN	18	9
≥ Grade 3 PN	8	4
Discontinuation due to PN (%)	2	< 1

VcR-CAP= bortezomib, rituximab, cyclophosphamide, doxorubicin, and prednisone; R-CHOP = rituximab, cyclophosphamide, doxorubicin, vincristine, and prednisone; PN = peripheral neuropathy

Peripheral neuropathy included the preferred terms: peripheral sensory neuropathy, neuropathy peripheral, peripheral motor neuropathy, and peripheral sensorimotor neuropathy

Elderly MCL patients
Although in patients aged ≥ 75 years, both VcR-CAP and R-CHOP were less tolerated, the serious adverse event rate in the VcR-CAP groups was 68 %, compared to 42 % in the R-CHOP group.

Notable differences in the safety profile of Bortezomib administered subcutaneously versus intravenously as single agent
Patients who received bortezomib subcutaneously compared to intravenous administration had lower overall incidence of treatment emergent adverse reactions that were Grade 3 or higher in toxicity, and a 5% lower incidence of discontinuation of bortezomib. The overall incidence of diarrhoea, gastrointestinal and abdominal pain, asthenic conditions, upper respiratory tract infections and peripheral neuropathies were lower in the subcutaneous group than in the intravenous group. In addition, the incidence of Grade 3 or higher peripheral neuropathies was lower, and the discontinuation rate due to peripheral neuropathies lower for the subcutaneous group as compared to the intravenous group.

Retreatment of patients with relapsed multiple myeloma
The most common all-grade adverse events occurring in patients were thrombocytopenia, neuropathy, anaemia, diarrhoea, and constipation. All grade peripheral neuropathy and grade ≥ 3 peripheral neuropathy were observed in patients.

4.9 Symptoms and Treatment of Overdose
In patients, overdose more than twice the recommended dose has been associated with the acute onset of symptomatic hypotension and thrombocytopenia with fatal outcomes.

There is no known specific antidote for bortezomib overdose. In the event of an overdose, the patient's vital signs should be monitored and appropriate supportive care given to monitor blood pressure (such as fluids, pressors, and/or isotropic agents) and body temperature.

5.1 Pharmacodynamics
Pharmacotherapeutic group: Antineoplastic agents, other antineoplastic agents, ATC code: L01XX32.

Mechanism of action
Bortezomib is a proteasome inhibitor. It is specifically designed to inhibit the chymotrypsin-like activity of the 26S proteasome in mammalian cells. The 26S proteasome is a large protein complex that degrades ubiquitinated proteins. The ubiquitin-proteasome pathway plays an essential role in regulating the turnover of specific proteins, thereby maintaining homeostasis within cells. Inhibition of the 26S proteasome prevents this targeted proteolysis and affects multiple signalling cascades within the cell, ultimately resulting in cancer cell death.

Bortezomib is highly selective for the proteasome. At 10 µM concentrations, bortezomib does not inhibit any of a wide variety of receptors and proteases screened and is more than 1,500-fold more selective for the proteasome than for its next preferred enzyme. The kinetics of proteasome inhibition were evaluated in vitro, and bortezomib was shown to dissociate from the proteasome with a *t*_{1/2} of 20 minutes, thus demonstrating that proteasome inhibition by bortezomib is reversible.

Bortezomib mediated proteasome inhibition affects cancer cells in a number of ways, including, but not limited to, altering regulatory proteins, which control cell cycle progression and nuclear factor kappa B (NF-κB) activation. Inhibition of the proteasome results in cell cycle arrest and apoptosis. NF-κB is a transcription factor whose activation is required for many aspects of tumorigenesis, including cell growth and survival, angiogenesis, cell-cell interactions, and metastasis. In myeloma, bortezomib affects the ability of myeloma cells to interact with the bone marrow microenvironment.

Experiments have demonstrated that bortezomib is cytotoxic to a variety of cancer cell types and that cancer cells are more sensitive to the pro-apoptotic effects of proteasome inhibition than normal cells. Bortezomib causes reduction of tumour growth in vivo in many tumour models, including multiple myeloma.

It is suggested that Bortezomib increases osteoblast differentiation and activity and inhibits osteoclast function. These effects have been observed in patients with multiple myeloma affected by an advanced osteolytic disease and treated with bortezomib.

5.2 Pharmacokinetic properties
Absorption
Following intravenous bolus administration of a 1.0 mg/m² and 1.3 mg/m² dose, the mean first-dose maximum plasma concentrations of bortezomib were 57 and 112 ng/ml, respectively. In subsequent doses, mean maximum plasma concentrations ranged from 67 to 106 ng/ml for the 1.0 mg/m² dose and 89 to 120 ng/ml for the 1.3 mg/m² dose.

Following an intravenous bolus or subcutaneous injection of a 1.3 mg/m² dose to patients with multiple myeloma, the total systemic exposure after repeat dose administration (AUC_{0-∞}) was equivalent for subcutaneous and intravenous administrations. The C_{max} after subcutaneous administration (20.4 ng/ml) was lower than intravenous (223 ng/ml). The AUC_{0-∞} geometric mean ratio was 0.59 and 95% confidence intervals were 80.18 %-122.80 %.

Distribution
The mean distribution volume (V_d) of bortezomib ranged from 1,659 l to 3,294 l following single- or repeated-dose intravenous administration of 1.0 mg/m² or 1.3 mg/m² to patients with multiple myeloma. This suggests that bortezomib distributes widely to peripheral tissues. Over a bortezomib concentration range of 0.01 to 1.0 µg/ml, the protein binding averaged 82.9% in human plasma. The fraction of bortezomib bound to plasma proteins was not concentration-dependent.

Bioretransformation
Bortezomib is primarily oxidatively metabolised via cytochrome P450 enzymes, 3A4, 2C19, and 1A2. The major metabolic pathway is a deconjugated metabolites that subsequently undergoes hydroxylation to several metabolites. Deconjugated-bortezomib metabolites are inactive as 26S proteasome inhibitors.

Elimination
The mean elimination half-life (t_{1/2}) of bortezomib upon multiple dosing ranged from 40-193 hours. Bortezomib is eliminated more rapidly following the first dose compared to subsequent doses. Mean total body clearances were 102 (84-116) hours. After correcting for the BSA effect, other demographics such as age, body weight and sex did not have clinically significant effects on bortezomib clearance. BSA-normalised clearance of bortezomib in pediatrics was similar to that observed in adults

Special populations
Hepatic impairment
When compared to patients with normal hepatic function, mild hepatic impairment did not alter dose-normalised bortezomib AUC. However, the dose-normalised mean AUC values were increased by approximately 60 % in patients with moderate or severe hepatic impairment. Lower starting dose is recommended in patients with moderate or severe hepatic impairment, and those patients should be closely monitored.

Renal impairment
Dose-normalised AUC and C_{max} for bortezomib exposure are comparable among all renal impairment with various degrees of renal impairment who were classified according to their creatinine clearance values (Cr-CL): normal, mild, moderate and severe.